Government Citizen Certificates & DigiLocker Handbook

Official Government Citizen Reference Manual

1. State Citizen Certificates (ServicePlus & State Portals)

Citizens can apply online for Income, Caste/Community, and Domicile/Residence certificates via state portals (MeeSeva, e-District, Nadakacheri, Aaple Sarkar) or ServicePlus (serviceonline.gov.in).

Income Certificates: Required for welfare subsidies and educational scholarships. Valid for one financial year. Requires salary slips, income tax documents, or self-declaration affidavit.

Community / Caste Certificates: Issued by the Revenue Department (Tahsildar / SDM) establishing SC/ST/OBC status. SC/ST certificates are permanent; OBC Non-Creamy Layer certificates require annual renewal.

Approved certificates are issued with verifiable QR codes and digital signatures within 7 to 15 working days.

2. DigiLocker Legal Framework & Document Issuance

DigiLocker is the Government of India flagship cloud wallet under Digital India.

Under Rule 9A of the IT Rules 2016, electronic records in DigiLocker issued by authorities are treated at par with original physical documents.

Citizens can fetch digitally signed Aadhaar, Driving License, Vehicle RC, and educational marksheets directly from official repositories using Aadhaar authentication.